

My commitment

Accountability session · Treasured Vessels Girls' Centre, Jinja

- ☐ I will not arrange, attend or bless a marriage involving anyone under 18.
- ☐ I will pay school fees before discretionary spending.
- ☐ I will do a named share of the care work at home, not "help".
- ☐ I will not repeat talk that shames a girl, and I will ask about the man.
- ☐ I will accompany a referral without taking over the decision.
- ☐ I will buy from women-led businesses, at a fair price.

MAKE IT SPECIFIC: A PROMISE NOBODY CAN CHECK IS NOT A PROMISE

One thing I will do this month

Who will ask me about it

By when

A promise to your household and your community, not to the centre. Nobody will collect this card.

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Running the session

Facilitator's sheet · about two hours · print one, copy the cards

SHAPE OF THE TWO HOURS

15 min	Why we are here. State the test up front: is she safer, freer, and more able to choose than she was before? Everything is measured against it.
30 min	Facilitated discussion, in small groups. What do men here actually do when a marriage is proposed for a girl under 18? Let the disagreement happen. It is the useful part.
20 min	The law, plainly. Minimum age 18 (Constitution, Article 31). Informal unions count (Children (Amendment) Act 2016). A sexual act with anyone under 18 is defilement (Penal Code s.129). Most of this is news to most rooms.
20 min	Positive parenting under real financial pressure. "Do not marry her off" is not advice unless something replaces it. Discuss what does.
20 min	Violence prevention, concretely. What is not acceptable; what to do when another man is doing it; why "it is a family matter" protects the person causing harm.
15 min	Commitment cards and referral contacts. Everyone leaves with both.

WATCH FOR THESE FOUR

- ☐ **Decisions transferring to men.** An ally removes obstacles; he does not choose destinations. Pay the fee, do not pick the school.
- ☐ **Pressure to reconcile.** Nobody in this room should be brokering a return to a partner who has caused harm. That is her decision alone.
- ☐ **Performance.** If involvement is visible to the community but nothing changes in his own household, it is a performance.
- ☐ **Men becoming the heroes.** Not marrying off a 14-year-old is the floor, not an achievement.

EVERYONE LEAVES WITH THESE

116 Uganda Child Helpline, free on any network, 24 hours

Treasured Vessels Girls' Centre, Jinja · +256 756 233 041 · +256 774 427 101

Your district probation and social welfare officer · the Child and Family Protection Unit at your nearest police station

TWO RULES FOR THE FACILITATOR

Do not collect the cards. A promise made to a visiting organisation is worth much less than one made to a household. Ask each man to name who will hold him to it instead.

Let it be uncomfortable. A session where everyone agrees with everything has not touched anything. Your job is to keep it honest and on time, not to keep it pleasant.